

h1 { color: #7a5230; font-size: 20pt; } h2 { color: #7a5230; font-size: 11pt; } h3 { color: #333333; font-size: 10pt; } p, li { font-size: 9pt; color: #1a1a1a; } th { background-color: #7a5230; color: #ffffff; font-size: 8pt; } td { border: 0.4px solid #d8d2c8; font-size: 8.5pt; } blockquote { color: #444444; font-size: 8.5pt; } code { font-family: DejaVuMono; font-size: 8pt; }

Little Duck Plushie

A round, squashy duckling worked in super-bulky chenille as a **single piece from tail to crown**, so there is no body-to-head seam. Only the wings and the beak are sewn on.

At a Glance

Finished size	about 16 cm (6.25 in) tall, 7.5 cm (3 in) wide
Yarn	super-bulky chenille (#6)
Hook	4.5 mm (US 7)
Skill	confident beginner
Time	1.5-2 hours
Pieces to sew	2 wings + 1 beak

Materials

- **Body yarn:** super-bulky chenille (#6), yellow — **about 25-35 g**. A 100 g ball makes two ducks comfortably, and three if your tension is on the tight side.
- **Details:** a small amount of orange yarn for the beak; black yarn or embroidery floss for the eyes.
- **Hook:** 4.5 mm (US 7)
- **Fiberfill:** **about 25-35 g**, packed firmly
- **Other:** yarn needle, stitch marker, pins

Gauge and Finished Size

Gauge. In super-bulky chenille (#6) on a 4.5 mm hook: about **8 mm per stitch** and **7 mm per round**.

Chenille varies a great deal between brands. Measure a 12-stitch swatch — about 10 cm — before you commit, because the finished height depends entirely on this.

Finished size. About **16 cm / 6.25 in tall** and **7.5 cm / 3 in wide** at the gauge above. Those figures come straight from the round count: 23 rounds at 7 mm, and a widest point of 30 stitches at 8 mm.

Making a smaller duck

The same pattern in a lighter yarn, on a 3.0 mm hook:

Yarn	Finished height
Velvet / bulky (#5)	10-12 cm
Aran / worsted (#4)	9-10 cm
DK / light worsted (#3)	7.5-8.5 cm

DK is often suggested for this, but it is fine enough that the duck lands at about 8 cm rather than 10-12 cm — a perfectly good result, just not the size most people expect. Choose velvet if the 10-12 cm size is what you want.

Skill Level

Confident beginner.

Techniques you will use

1. **Magic ring** — the start of the body and each wing.
2. **Working in a continuous spiral**, with a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round. There is no join to

count from.

3. **Invisible decreases** — see the note at the end of the pattern.

4. **Working around both sides of a starting chain** — the beak. You work along one side, round the end, and back along the other.

5. **Working through both layers at once** to close the flat edge of each wing.

6. **Embroidery** for the eyes.

7. **Sewing on** the wings and the beak.

Abbreviations (US terms)

Abbreviation	Meaning
MR	magic ring
ch	chain
sc	single crochet
inc	increase, 2 sc in one stitch
dec	invisible decrease
sl st	slip stitch
FLO	front loops only
FO	fasten off
(n)	stitch count

1. Body and Head — One Piece

Worked from the tail end up. The waist at R10–R12 and the reflare at R13–R14 are what separate the body from the head without a seam.

The body and the head are the **same diameter** — 30 stitches each, about 76 mm. The 18-stitch waist between them is what reads as a neck.

For a smaller head, skip the R14 reflare: work R14–R19 as sc in each st around at 24 stitches. The closing rounds are written for 30 stitches, so they must change too:

Rnd	Instruction	Sts
R20	[2 sc, dec] x6	(18)
R21	[sc, dec] x6	(12)
R22	dec x6	(6)

The duck then closes three rounds earlier, so it is about 2 cm shorter, and the head reads as distinctly smaller than the body.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[sc, inc] x6	(18)	
R4	[2 sc, inc] x6	(24)	
R5	[3 sc, inc] x6	(30)	
R6	sc in each st around	(30)	body at full width
R7	sc in each st around	(30)	wings attach at R6–R9
R8	sc in each st around	(30)	
R9	sc in each st around	(30)	
R10	[3 sc, dec] x6	(24)	start stuffing now
R11	sc in each st around	(24)	
R12	[2 sc, dec] x6	(18)	the waist is closing
R13	[2 sc, inc] x6	(24)	
R14	[3 sc, inc] x6	(30)	head begins
R15	sc in each st around	(30)	
R16	sc in each st around	(30)	eyes between R16 and R17
R17	sc in each st around	(30)	
R18	sc in each st around	(30)	beak across R16–R18
R19	sc in each st around	(30)	
R20	[3 sc, dec] x6	(24)	

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R21	[2 sc, dec] x6	(18)	stuff the head, shaping the cheeks evenly
R22	[sc, dec] x6	(12)	add the final small pieces of stuffing
R23	dec x6	(6)	

Finish. FO leaving a long tail. Thread the tail through the **FLO** of each of the 6 remaining stitches, pull tight to close, knot and bury the end.

Start stuffing at R10, not R12. The waist narrows from 30 stitches to 18 across R10–R12. Once it is closed you can no longer reach the body, and packing firm fiberfill through an 18-stitch neck is slow and lumpy. Fill the body before the waist finishes closing.

2. Wings — Make 2

Rnd	Instruction	Sts
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)
R2	inc in each st around	(12)
R3	sc in each st around	(12)
R4	sc in each st around	(12)

Finish. Do not stuff. Flatten the piece and sc 6 sts across both layers to close the edge — this takes the 12 stitches down to 6 and leaves a flat half-disc about 30 mm across. FO, leaving a long tail.

Sew each wing to the side of the body spanning **R6–R9**, the widest part of the body below the waist, angled slightly back. R10–R12 is the waist and R13 upward is the head; wings placed there sit on the neck.

3. Beak — Make 1

Worked around both sides of a starting chain of 5. Each side works into four chains — the three along the side plus the corner chain — and between them all five chains are used, so nothing is left unworked.

Ch 5.

Rnd 1. Starting in the 2nd ch from hook: sc in next 3 ch, 3 sc in the last ch. Rotate to work along the underside of the chain: sc in next 3, 2 sc in the last loop. **[11]**

Rnd 2. inc, 2 sc, inc, 2 sc, inc, 2 sc, inc, sc. **[15]**

Sl st in the next st and FO, leaving a long tail.

How the chain is used. Side one takes 3 sc plus a 3-st corner into the final chain, touching four chains. Side two takes 3 sc plus a 2-st corner into the final loop, again touching four. The middle three chains are worked twice, once from each side. Rnd 1 therefore totals 11 stitches. Rnd 2's four increases and seven plain stitches consume all 11 and produce 15.

Do not stuff the beak. Flatten it before pinning so it sits as a flat lens rather than a puffy tube.

About the size. As written the beak finishes about 50 mm long, which is two-thirds of the head width — a bold, cartoon beak that suits a duckling well. For a daintier duck, work **Rnd 1 only** and finish there: 11 stitches gives a beak about 37 mm long.

4. Face

Embroider the black eyes **between R16 and R17**, about **7–8 stitches apart**. At this gauge that is 56–64 mm on a 76 mm head, which leaves comfortable room at the edges.

Pin the beak horizontally across R16–R18, centered between the eyes, and sew around the outer edge.

5. Assembly Order

1. **Stuff the body firmly from R10** as the waist begins to close — it is much harder to reach once the neck narrows.
2. **Embroider the eyes** before the head is fully closed, while you can still reach inside to bury the ends.
3. **Sew the beak** across R16–R18, centered between the eyes.
4. **Sew the wings** to R6–R9, one on each side, angled slightly back.
5. **Top up the stuffing** through R22 and close.

Safety and Selling

This pattern uses **embroidered eyes**, which avoids the small-parts hazard that safety eyes create — a real advantage if you sell these.

If you sell finished ducks as toys:

- Toys for children in the EU must carry CE marking under EN 71; in the United States they must meet the CPSIA lead and phthalate limits and ASTM F963. Independent testing is the only way to know whether your toys meet those standards.
- Check that seams hold under a firm pull, and that chenille pile does not shed loose fibers — both are common failure points with plush yarn.
- Include a hang tag or listing line with your **materials, your name as maker, and an age recommendation**.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Duck is much taller than 16 cm	Your chenille is thicker than the stated gauge. Measure a 12-stitch swatch: at 10 mm per stitch this pattern finishes near 20 cm.
Duck is much shorter	Finer yarn. See the smaller-duck table above — DK on a 3.0 mm hook gives 7–8 cm, not 10–12 cm.
Wings sit on the neck	They are too high. R6–R9 is the body; R10–R12 is the waist.
Beak leaves a gap	Each side must be worked into four chains. If you have a chain left over, one side was worked short.
Beak puffs instead of lying flat	Do not stuff it, and flatten it before you pin.
Stuffing shows	Chenille hides stuffing well; if it shows, the hook is too large for the yarn.
Head flops	Pack the waist at R10–R12 firmly before the head reflare.
Cannot reach the body to stuff it	You started too late. Begin at R10, while the waist is still 24 stitches wide.

Invisible Decrease

An invisible decrease gives a flatter join than a standard decrease, which shows at this scale.

1. Insert your hook under the **front loop only** of the next stitch.
2. Insert your hook under the **front loop only** of the stitch after that. You now have three loops on the hook.
3. Yarn over and pull through the first two loops.
4. Yarn over and pull through both remaining loops.

Care

Surface clean with a damp cloth and mild soap; do not machine wash — chenille piles mat and shed in agitation. Dry flat, away from heat. Fluff the pile with a clean pet slicker brush once dry.

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